

Insight Team Design Brief

Purpose

This document is the shareable design brief for the full product team.

It is meant to align: - The dashboard team - The mobile sound-collection app team - The landing-page team - Engineering, product, and design reviewers

This document is intended to stand on its own for day-to-day team use. If someone follows this brief well, they should already be aligned with the intended product design direction.

Design North Star

Everything we build should feel: - Clear - Calm - Precise - Trustworthy - Premium through restraint - Operational, not decorative

The product should look like a serious industrial technology platform, not a startup marketing experiment.

What We Are Optimizing For

- Fast understanding
- Low cognitive load
- Confidence under real-world use
- Consistency across surfaces
- Accessibility and usability
- A polished enterprise-grade impression

We are not optimizing for: - Trendy visual effects - Dense decoration - Novelty for its own sake - Generic AI-product aesthetics

Shared Design Principles

1. Clarity over flair

- Every screen should make the next action obvious.
- Visual hierarchy should come from structure, spacing, contrast, and type.
- Interfaces should never feel noisy or performative.

2. Premium through restraint

- Premium does not mean shiny.
- Premium means disciplined spacing, careful typography, strong alignment, and consistent interaction patterns.
- Use fewer visual ideas, executed well.

3. Industrial minimalism

- Clean surfaces
- Structured layouts
- Quiet chrome
- Strong operational signals
- No decorative gradients, patterns, glows, or glass effects

4. Consistency is part of the product

- Similar actions must look the same.
- Similar states must look the same.
- Similar workflows must follow the same interaction logic.

5. Usability beats cleverness

- The user should not need to decode the interface.
- Plain language beats jargon.
- Feedback should be immediate and easy to understand.

Shared Visual Direction

Overall feel

- Modern
- Enterprise-ready
- Clean
- Confident
- Understated

Color direction

- Restrained industrial neutrals
- One clear accent color for interaction
- Semantic colors reserved for system state and machine state

Non-negotiable semantic meanings

- Green = OK / healthy / success
- Amber = deteriorating / warning / attention
- Red = failing / destructive / critical
- Blue = interaction, focus, selected state, information

Blue is not a health state. Green is not a brand color.

Typography direction

- Clean, highly legible sans-serif for UI
- Monospace only for values, IDs, timestamps, and technical data
- Strong hierarchy without oversized text

Recommended implementation direction: - Use one modern sans-serif family across product surfaces - Use one monospace family for technical and numeric content - Keep headings disciplined and readable, not oversized - Prefer strong spacing and alignment over expressive display typography

Motion direction

- Minimal
- Functional
- Fast
- Never decorative

Allowed motion: - Hover feedback - Focus transitions - Menu and dialog transitions - Loading indicators - Live-state motion only when it communicates something real

Avoid: - Floating animations - Animated gradients - Decorative shimmer - Pulsing UI that does not represent a real alert or live state

Shared Theme Rules

- Light and dark modes should both feel intentional and fully supported where themes apply
- Theme changes must not alter layout, spacing, or interaction patterns
- Accent color is for interaction and selection, not decoration
- Semantic state colors must remain stable across all product surfaces

Shared Token Intent

Even if teams are using different stacks, they should follow the same token logic.

Every surface should define consistent roles for: - Canvas background - Primary surface - Secondary or muted surface - Border - Primary text - Secondary text - Accent - Focus - Success - Warning - Danger - Info - Disabled

Teams should avoid raw one-off color choices in product UI. Colors should have roles, not just values.

Shared Baseline Design Decisions

This section defines the core decisions teams should follow directly, even without any other document.

Fonts

Primary UI font: - IBM Plex Sans

Monospace font: - IBM Plex Mono

Fallbacks: - system-ui , sans-serif for UI - ui-monospace , monospace for technical and numeric content

Rules: - Use one sans-serif family across dashboard, mobile app, and landing page - Use monospace only for values, timestamps, IDs, logs, and technical metadata - Do not introduce decorative display fonts

Core light-theme colors

Role	Swatch	Value
Canvas		#F3F5F7
Surface		FFFFFF
Muted surface		#E9EEF3
Border		#D5DEE7
Strong border		#B7C4D1
Primary text		#0F1720
Secondary text		#475467
Accent		#155EEF
Accent hover		#004EEB
Success		#15803D
Warning		#B45309
Danger		#B42318
Info		#0F6E8C

Core dark-theme colors

Role	Swatch	Value
Canvas		#0B1218
Surface		#111A22
Muted surface		#1B2A36
Border		#2A3A47
Strong border		#425466
Primary text		#F3F5F7
Secondary text		#C7D0D9
Accent		#6EA8FE
Accent hover		#8BC0FF
Success		#22A75A
Warning		#D18A1D
Danger		#E35D5B
Info		#4FA7C6

Shared spacing and radius baseline

Spacing scale: - 4 - 8 - 12 - 16 - 20 - 24 - 32 - 40 - 48

Radius scale: - Small: 6px - Medium: 8px - Large: 12px

Rules: - Buttons and inputs: 8px radius - Cards and panels: 12px radius - Do not exceed 12px rounding unless the element is intentionally pill-shaped

Shared sizing baseline

- Minimum button/control height: 40px
- Minimum touch target for mobile or tablet use: 44px
- Header or top bar height target: 64px

Shared motion baseline

- Default transition duration: 150ms
- Extended transition duration: 180ms to 200ms
- Motion should be subtle and functional only

Shared semantic state mappings

Use these meanings consistently: - OK = success color family - Deteriorating or Warning = warning color family - Failing or Critical = danger color family - Info = informational blue family

Never use accent blue as a health-state color. Never use green as a brand or decorative color.

Cross-Product Guidance

1. Dashboard

Primary role: - Operational monitoring and decision support

Users: - Plant operators - Maintenance teams - Reliability engineers - Operations managers

What it should feel like: - Calm under pressure - Data-rich but readable - Serious and dependable

Dashboard priorities: - Show machine state first - Show recommended action clearly - Keep advanced controls secondary - Make alerts and deterioration impossible to miss - Preserve consistency across machine status, ingestion, live monitor, and insights

Dashboard anti-patterns: - Fancy analytics chrome - Decorative cards - Overuse of color - Motion-heavy dashboards - Hidden critical states

2. Mobile Sound Collection App

Primary role: - Capture machine sound reliably using a phone

Important context: - This is a field utility, not a customer-facing showcase app - It may be used in noisy, rushed, or imperfect environments - It must prioritize clarity, state feedback, and reliability over branding

What it should feel like: - Fast - Focused - Tactile - Reliable - Hard to misuse

Mobile priorities: - One primary action per screen - Large touch targets - Very clear recording states - Very clear upload and sync states - Strong permission guidance for microphone, storage, and connectivity where relevant - Good handling for offline, weak-network, queued, and failed-upload conditions - Minimal navigation depth

Recommended mobile state language: - Ready to record - Recording - Recording paused - Saved locally - Uploading - Uploaded - Sync failed

Mobile anti-patterns: - Marketing-style UI - Small touch targets - Hidden permission requirements - Ambiguous recording state - Weak feedback after capture - Complex multi-step forms on small screens

3. Landing Page

Primary role: - Explain the product clearly and build trust

What it should feel like: - Premium - Credible - Modern - Direct - Grounded in real product value

Landing-page priorities: - Make the problem and value proposition obvious quickly - Show the product as operational technology, not vague AI magic - Use real screenshots, product language, and concrete workflows where possible - Prioritize trust signals, clarity, and proof over spectacle - Keep conversion paths obvious and limited

Landing-page anti-patterns: - Abstract AI art - Empty claims about intelligence or transformation - Purple gradients, mesh backgrounds, and generic SaaS hero sections - Overselling "real-time" or "AI" without explaining the product - UI elements that feel unrelated to the actual product

Shared Component Principles

These apply across all surfaces even if the implementation stacks differ.

Buttons

- One clearly dominant primary action per surface
- Secondary and ghost actions should stay visually quiet
- Disabled buttons must remain legible
- Loading buttons must keep their size and label context

Expected states: - Default - Hover - Pressed - Focus-visible - Loading - Disabled

Inputs and forms

- Labels must be explicit
- Helper text and errors must be close to the control
- Validation must be clear and specific
- Avoid placeholder-only labeling

Expected states: - Default - Hover - Focus-visible - Error - Read-only - Disabled

Alerts and notifications

- Severity should be instantly recognizable
- Critical states should not be subtle
- Notification styles should be consistent across products
- Use persistent in-context alerts for important operational issues

Status indicators

- Status must always include text, not color alone
- Use the same meaning for the same color across products
- Status language should remain simple and operational

Core state language: - OK - Warning or Deteriorating - Critical or Failing - Info

Shared Layout Principles

- Keep shells visually quiet
- Let the main content carry the visual emphasis
- Use consistent spacing and alignment
- Avoid over-fragmenting screens into too many card types
- Make key actions easy to find without visual clutter

Practical guidance: - Prefer a stable grid over ad hoc panel placement - Keep primary actions near the top of the working area - Use restrained card and panel patterns - Avoid overly wide reading blocks - Ensure layouts still work comfortably on tablet widths where relevant

Shared Content Principles

Use language that is: - Direct - Operational - Calm - Specific

Prefer: - Machine state - Wear trend - Abnormal behavior - Recommended action - Last update - Recording status - Upload status

Avoid: - Buzzwords - Unexplained acronyms in primary UI - Cute microcopy - Marketing copy inside operational interfaces

Team Rules

- Do not invent page-level color systems
- Do not introduce decorative effects outside the design system
- Do not add new component variants without checking the shared system first
- Do not reinterpret semantic colors locally
- Do not ship surfaces that feel unrelated to each other

If a team needs a new variant, token, or exception: - define the problem clearly - explain why the current system is insufficient - propose the smallest possible addition - validate it in light and dark contexts where applicable

Quick Review Checklist

Before shipping a new screen or major UI change, ask: - Does this feel clear and calm? - Does this look premium because it is disciplined, not because it is flashy? - Is the next action obvious? - Are status, alert, and error states unmistakable? - Is the interface consistent with the rest of the product family? - Are we relying on real product clarity instead of decorative styling? - Would this still feel strong if all gradients and effects were removed?

Recommended Team Usage

- For every developer working on dashboard, mobile, and landing-page surfaces
- Use it during PR review for visual and UX alignment
- Revisit this brief whenever a new product surface is introduced

Bottom Line

DInsight should feel like one product family.

The dashboard should feel operational. The mobile app should feel reliable and task-focused. The landing page should feel credible and premium.

Different surfaces can have different emphasis, but they should all reflect the same product values: clarity, trust, discipline, and usefulness.